

WEIXUAN DING

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EDUCATION

University of Helsinki, Helsinki, Finland
Faculty of Science,
Master of Science in Data Science

August 2026 — June 2028 (Expected)
GPA: N/A

Wuhan University, Wuhan, China
School of Cyber Science and Engineering,
Bachelor of Engineering in Cyberspace Security

September 2022 — June 2026
GPA: 3.81/4.00

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Client-side Ownership Protection for Federated LLMs
Stevens Institute of Technology - Research Intern

December 2024 - May 2026
Advisor: Hao Wang

- Formulate a novel threat model for model stealing and unauthorized distribution in federated LLMs, and conduct a systematic analysis of why existing watermarking approaches fail in this setting.
- Address the main challenges in federated LLM fingerprinting, investigate model behavior during aggregation, and establish efficient and robust black-box watermarking and verification mechanisms.
- Launch experimental research, handle federated fine-tuning and evaluation pipelines, and build practical expertise in large-scale model optimization, data analysis and experimental research planning.

Open-World Object Placement via Imaginary Search
University of Louisville - Research Intern

October 2024 - May 2025
Advisor: Zeyan Liu

- Conducted comprehensive research on open-world object placement, investigating how multimodal language models can efficiently reason on spatial relationships and scene context.
- Designed a training-free framework that integrates iterative decision-making, multimodal reasoning, and heuristic search for open-world visual reasoning.
- Achieved state-of-the-art performance on 2 benchmarks against 7 baseline methods, and produced a manuscript under review, providing insights in open-world visual reasoning.

PROJECT EXPERIENCE

Intelligent Risk Monitoring System in Decentralized Finance
Team Member

August 2024 - October 2024

- Collaborated in the design of TrxLLM, a blockchain transaction risk monitoring system that integrates graph neural networks and Transformer to analyze complex transaction dependencies and malicious behaviors.
- Developed the web system using Vue 3 and Vite to support real-time transaction visualization, address risk evaluation, and interactive monitoring functionalities for practical deployment.
- Validated system effectiveness through large-scale experiments on 80K transactions, achieving 92% accuracy in malicious transaction detection, 85% accuracy in address risk assessment.

ACHIEVEMENTS

First Prize in the National College Student Blockchain + Application Competition
Yearly Model Student of Academic Records
Yearly Third-Class Scholarship

Fall 2024
Fall 2024 & 2025
Fall 2024 & 2025

PUBLICATIONS

Conferences

- [ICONIP’26] **W. Ding**, S Liu, H Pei, Z. Liu, “Presto: Efficient, Training-free, and Open-world Object Placement via Imaginary Search”, In Proceedings of the 33rd International Conference on Neural Information Processing, 2026

SKILLS

Programming Languages	Python, C/C++, SQL
AI Stack	PyTorch, Transformers, PEFT, LangChain, vLLM
Tools	Matplotlib, NumPy, Pandas, Git, Docker, Vue
Languages	Chinese(Native), English(Proficent)